

Connected passers support each other

Endgame Technique

THE IDEA

Passed pawns on adjacent files can protect one another as they advance. Their strength rises when the defending king cannot blockade both or when promotion threats gain tempi. Careless advancement can separate them and remove their mutual support.

WORKED EXAMPLE

White pawns on e5 and f5 can create two promotion threats. Pushing one far ahead may let the enemy king blockade the other and capture the advanced pawn. The correct order depends on king position and tactical checks.

TRY IT BEFORE READING ON

What should guide the order of connected-pawn advances?

ANSWER AND REASONING

Maintain support, restrict the defending king, and calculate whether either promotion comes with check. The most advanced pawn is not always the one to push next.

TAKE THIS INTO YOUR NEXT GAME

Coordinate passed pawns as a pair.